Flourish
LEGAL WELL-BEING

Cheat Sheet: **Cognitive Reframing**

One simple, powerful way to manage anxiety is to reinterpret it as a more positive emotion: **excitement.**

This works because anxiety and excitement are physiologically similar.

Both anxiety and excitement are "high arousal" states: they involve elevated heartrate, accelerated breathing, and the release of energizing hormones.

Research shows that, when people reframe anxiety as excitement, they:

- Perform better at anxiety-provoking tasks
- Feel more excited
- Tend to see issues as opportunities rather than as threats

This can be as simple as saying the words **"I'm excited"** (out loud or in your head) when facing an anxiety-provoking situation.